is also involvement by the Indian navy in the northern Indian Ocean against Somali pirates' activities. India also has interests in the mining of diamonds in Zimbabwe with an investment of US$1.2 million; and has reserves of uranium in Namibia and Malawi.

Africa supplies some 20% of India's fuel imports. Thirty per cent of India's energy is met by oil with 70% of this commodity being imported. The remaining 70% is met through domestic coal reserves. It is expected that India's demand for energy will double by 2015, pushing India to import 90% of its oil. India is therefore obliged to diversify its energy suppliers through oil exploration and production. This is undertaken by the Oil and National Gas Corporation (ONGC), which has ventured into Africa, e.g. oil exploration in Libya and Nigeria, investment in hydrocarbons in Sudan and offshore drilling in the Ivory Coast.

India's foreign policy is characterised by a readiness 'to cooperate with various international partners, without becoming too strongly bound to any particular partner or possibly entering into a relationship of dependency'. As a result, India maintains strong ties with Russia (its main supplier of weapons). India is also developing positive relations with various Asian partners, including Japan and South Korea – with whom India signed strategic partnership agreements in 2006 and 2010, respectively – as well as the resource-rich Central Asian states.

China

From the 1960s, China was involved in several liberation struggles in Africa through provision of military training and logistical support. It also provided development aid such as the Tanzania–Zambia Railway (TAZARA), which remains the crown jewel of China's assistance. With a US$412 million interest-free construction loan, the TAZARA was designed and built in the 1960s to offer an alternative to South African ports to ship minerals from Central Africa.

In addition, it served an ideological and practical role within Beijing's strategy to oppose Moscow's authority in East Africa. China's interests in Africa were renewed by its increasing need for Africa's natural resources, yet, without a doubt, African political leaders have long appreciated China's presence. Popular opinion has always remained mixed, with South Africans listing fear of China as the second most common political opinion about threats to the country, according to recent Pew surveys.

China has four main interests in Africa: (1) access to raw materials; (2) access to new markets; (3) political influence; and (4) isolation of Taiwan from African states. According to US scholar David Shinn, 'China imports about 90% of its